MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE

Approved 8/21/2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
August 7, 2024

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m. by Chairman Jeff Haskell.

COMMISSIONERS PRESENT

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Samantha Pitchford, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis and District 8 George Gilmore

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 9 Rick Fancon

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps and members of the public

JUSTICE

1. Legal Services Special Assistant Prosecuting Attorney (SAPA) – Discussion
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, Seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the contract as presented between the Clare County Prosecuting Attorney and Jason D. Pernick, a Special Assistant Prosecuting Attorney to provide legal services in accordance with the warrant/case review duties of an assistant prosecuting attorney starting August 8, 2024 through December 31, 2024, Chairman Haskell asked for discussion, after discussion roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Housler, Kleinhardt, Pitchford and Haskell
   Nays: (1) being Commissioner Gilmore
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Fancon
   Motion carried

HUMAN AND SOCIAL SERVICE

1. Housing Needs Assessment
   Administrator Phelps confirmed that there is a housing shortage in Clare County and that Grants are difficult to get when a county doesn't have a Housing Needs Assessment. Administrator helps would like to partner with other counties and have a joint assessment completed. A Housing Needs Assessment cost is generally $58,000.00 and Administrator Phelps would like to contribute $5,000.00 on behalf of Clare County out of Program Income dollars in Community Development. Chairman Haskell agreed to have this issue placed on the August Agenda.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES

1. Materials Management Planning
   Clare County is required to implement a Materials Management Plan within the next three years that will take the place of the Solid Waste Plan. Counties have been encouraged by EAGLE to partner with other counties to develop this plan. Clare County has joined together with Gladwin, Osceola, Mecosta, Isabella and Gratiot Counties and has been meeting twice a month developing committees and bylaws. Each County is required to appoint a Designated Planning Agent (DPA). Administrator Phelps has been acting as the DPA, but the Commissioners will have to appoint her, a County Commissioner and one other community member at the next Board of Commissioner Meeting as DPA's.

Committee of the Whole Meeting
August 7, 2024

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Two Factor Authentication
   The State of Michigan is requiring that all law enforcement information networks are to have two factor authentications in place no later than October 1, 2024 as an additional security measure. Administrator Phelps noted that there is funding in the computer budget to fund the $22,000.00 costs. Chairman Haskell will place this item on the agenda for the next meeting.

2. Health Insurance Discussion
   Priority Health submitted a quote for health insurance since the last presentation that offers a significant savings to the County ($68,000.00) and employee contributions would stay the same as they are currently.

   Administrator Phelps also discussed the option of offering an employee a $700.00 per month payment if the employee does not take the health insurance or a health saving account (HSA) instead of taking the health insurance. That would come to approximately $165,000.00 savings.

   Blue Care Network (BCN) would create an increase in cost to the County of 7.5% in addition to an increase to the employees.

   Commissioner Gilmore mentioned that the nice thing about not opting out of PA 152 would allow more flexibility in negotiating with the employees/unions because the employees see their wages and don't always consider what a good insurance plan they have or what it saves them. Administrator Phelps confirmed that PA 152 would be a cost savings of $338,000.00 to the county and a significant increase to the employees. Commissioner Majewski does not believe the cost burden should be placed entirely on the employees.

3. Closed Session – Negotiations
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, Seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to go into closed session to discuss the negotiation of a collective bargaining agreement. (MCL 15.268 (C), roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Majewski, Hoefling, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis, Pitchford, Housler and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Fancon
   Motion carried

Entered into closed session at 9:40 a.m.
Back in open session at 11:52 a.m.

Commissioner Pitchford and Commissioner Majewski left the meeting during closed session.

Meeting adjourned at 11:52 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

Jeff Haskell, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners